

Meron Gebrehiwet

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Software Engineer with experience modernising large-scale financial systems at American Express within the MARS (Modern Accounts Receivable Systems) organisation. Proven track record of owning and delivering internal platforms that improve engineering productivity and operational efficiency. Experienced across backend, frontend and platform tooling, with a strong focus on automation, performance optimisation and measurable impact. Passionate about building scalable systems, reducing manual processes and delivering practical solutions that create real business value.

Experience

American Express – Modern Accounts Receivable Systems (MARS)

Software Engineer | London, UK | September 2024 – Present

Modernising a global legacy accounts receivable platform into reactive microservices while owning internal engineering and operational tooling adopted across teams.

MARS Orchestrator (Golang) – Engineering Platform Tool

Designed and built a GitHub Enterprise CLI managing 230+ repositories across the MARS organisation.

- Developed the platform entirely in **Go**, leveraging concurrency and efficient API handling to perform large-scale repository management operations reliably and at speed.
- Automated bulk GitHub Actions workflow rollout, branch protection configuration, repository settings management, and team governance across 230+ repositories.
- Significantly accelerated the organisation-wide migration from Jenkins to GitHub Actions by enabling centralised workflow orchestration while dynamically applying repository-specific variables and configurations.
- Eliminated the need for manual per-repository workflow setup, reducing migration effort from hours of repetitive configuration work to automated executions completed in seconds.
- Standardised repository governance and CI/CD configuration across the organisation, reducing configuration drift and improving engineering compliance and security consistency.
- Built reusable tooling to automatically point repositories to centrally maintained GitHub Actions workflows, improving maintainability and simplifying future platform-wide CI/CD updates.
- Improved developer productivity by reducing operational overhead and enabling engineering teams to onboard repositories into GitHub Actions rapidly and consistently.
- Acted as sole maintainer, roadmap owner, and primary platform contributor, driving feature development and organisational adoption.

MARS Account Timeline Tool (React, Java)

Developed a visual account lifecycle UI to replace legacy green-screen workflows used by Customer Care Professionals.

- Visualised billing events, backdated payments and account changes in a timeline interface.

- Introduced response-level caching and optimised API aggregation to minimise microservice round-trips, improving UI render performance and reducing account load times for CCPs.
- Reduced average call handling time by 2–3 minutes (~10–15% efficiency gain).
- Improved operational throughput and enhanced customer experience.

Core Platform Engineering

- Contributed to MARS API Service (Java, Project Reactor, Cassandra), a central aggregation layer integrating multiple microservices.
- Worked on migration of legacy systems into reactive microservices architecture.
- Contributed to Kubernetes-based ephemeral environment tooling enabling local orchestration of distributed microservices for development and testing.

Technical Stack

Java, Golang, Spring Boot, Project Reactor, Cassandra, React, Kubernetes, GitHub Enterprise, REST APIs, Microservices Architecture

Education

Corndel

Software Engineer Diploma (level 4)

St Aloysius RC College

9 GCSE's (A* - C)

A - Levels:

Maths (B), Economics (B), Sociology (C)

KBM Accounting

AAT Level 2, AAT Level 3

Interests & Hobbies

- Football and staying active through regular gym training
- Playing video games, with an interest in problem-solving, strategy, and competitive play
- Anime and animated series, particularly story-driven and character-focused genres